



YOU ARE **17 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

160 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby's jaw continues to grow throughout the pregnancy, but at this time it can still appear to be quite short. The early tooth buds are hardening within both jaws and, just as with the other bones, calcium is being laid down to strengthen their structure.

“ Around this time, you may become aware of your baby moving, although for some women first movements are felt much later. ”

Although your baby is very active, she's not big enough for you to feel any but the strongest kicks on the walls of your uterus. "Quickening" is the term used to describe these first movements, which feel like tiny flutterings or bubbles in your lower abdomen. You may not notice them or not realize that they are the baby at first, since they feel similar to having gas.

If you've been pregnant before, you will be more familiar with the sensation and able to recognize it. First-time moms generally don't feel movements until a bit later, at about 18 to 20 weeks (see [You are 19 weeks and 3 days](#)), so don't worry if you haven't felt anything yet. The flutterings become more persistent and definite over time, and there will eventually be recognizable kicks and nudges.

Once you can feel the activities, you will become very conscious of them and may become aware of a pattern to them.

Babies move when they are asleep and awake. The reason you are less likely to feel your baby move when you're active is that you are likely to be distracted yourself and miss some movement.